



# FUNDAMENTALS OF OPEN SOURCE IT AND CLOUD COM...

## INSTALLING LINUX

### Backup

## Backing Up a Linux System

There are many methods to create a backup of a Linux system. The most important aspect is backing up the data and the configuration files for various services. The configuration files are generally located in the `/etc` directory. The user data normally stored in `/home` should also be backed up. Backing up the `/boot` directory may be useful. There is no point in backing up the `/proc` and `/sys` directories, as they are pseudo-filesystem directories that are regenerated at boot time. Which backup applications are available?

Select "Expand" to learn more about some of the backup options available.

### Backup Applications & Utilities

#### tar

[Close ^](#)

It is an easy-to-use backup utility. You can read more about `tar` in the [available documentation](#).

```
tar -cvf <target_file> <source-files or directory>
```

An example of backing up the `/home` directory:

```
# tar -cvf /opt/backup.tar /home
```

#### rsync

[Close ^](#)

`rsync` backs up differences via a block-by-block compare; this saves time by not continuously backing up the same thing. `rsync` uses ssh and ssh-formatted command structure, including SSL encryption on the connection. `rsync` has a vast array of options.

An example of backing up the `/home` directory:

```
# rsync -rzvh --exclude *.cache/ /home/. \ /opt/backups/
```

## Amanda

[Close ^](#)

Amanda (**A**dvanced **M**aryland **A**utomatic **N**etwork **D**isk **A**rchiver) uses native utilities (including tar and dump) but is far more robust and controllable. Amanda is generally available on Enterprise Linux systems through the usual repositories.

## Bacula

[Close ^](#)

Bacula is designed for automatic backup on heterogenous networks. It can be rather complicated to use and is recommended (by its authors) only to experienced administrators. Bacula is generally available on Enterprise Linux systems through the usual repositories.